NATIONAL GOVERNMENT CONSTITUENCIES DEVELOPMENT FUND
Maendeleo kwa Wote · OCEO, Field Activity Planning and Monitoring

OCEO Guide for Heads of Department

From your first sign-in to a closed activity · October 2026

RESTRICTED

Welcome to OCEO. This is the Field Activity Planning and Monitoring system the Office of the CEO uses to plan, approve and follow up field activities. As a Head of Department, you use it to send your department's activity memos to the CEO, to keep your workplan and budget, and to report what was done after each activity. This guide walks you through each of those tasks, in the order you will normally do them.

You do not need to read it all at once. Sections 1 and 2 get you in. After that, turn to the section you need. Button and menu names are written in **green bold**, just as they appear on the screen.

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The journey of a memo at a glance

You	Assistant or Chief of Staff	CEO	The team	You
Prepare the memo, team and costs	Reviews it, returns it or forwards it	Approves or declines it, and instructs Finance and Procurement	Goes to the field	Report what was done and spent

There is no direct route to the CEO: every memo is reviewed first. If a reviewer sends a memo back to you, you correct it and send it again to the same office.

> **OCEO is confidential.** Do not share your password or let anyone else use your account. You see your own department's work only. Everything you open, print or download is recorded in the access log.

1 Getting into OCEO

Your first sign-in

When you are made Head of Department, OCEO sends you an email with the subject **"OCEO: set your password"**. It goes to the email address on the staff list.

1. Open the email and press the button in it. The link works for a limited time, so use it soon.
2. Type a new password twice and press **Reset password**. Choose one you have not used anywhere else.
3. Sign in with your email and the new password, then press **Sign in**.
4. The first time only, read the NG-CDF Board Data Privacy Statement, tick to agree and accept it.
5. If you are asked to set up two-factor sign-in, scan the code with an authenticator app on your phone and type the six-digit number it shows. From then on, OCEO asks for that number when you sign in.

> **Did not get the email?** Check your spam or junk folder first. If it is not there, ask the System Administrator to check your email on the staff list and press **Email password link** on your account.

If you forget your password

1. On the sign-in page press **Forgot password?**
2. Type your work email and press **Send reset link**. The page gives the same answer whatever email you type, so it cannot be used to find out who has an account.
3. Open the email, set a new password and sign in.

After several wrong passwords your account is locked for a while. Resetting your password unlocks it straight away.

2 Finding your way around

The menu on the left shows only what a Head of Department uses:

Menu	What you do there
Activity memos	Prepare memos, follow each one through review and decision, and submit the activity report. The number beside it is how many memos need you.
Staff list	Add the officers in your department so you can put them on a team.
Workplan and budget	Prepare your department's workplan and budget for the financial year and send it to the CEO.
Instructions	Only for departments the CEO instructs, such as Finance and Supply Chain. See section 12.

You will not see the dashboard, the register, the calendar or the reports. Those belong to the Office of the CEO.

Alerts

The **bell** at the top of the page shows new alerts, for example when a memo is returned to you or approved. A small pop-up also appears when an alert arrives while you have OCEO open. Press an alert to go straight to the memo.

When something needs you to act, you also get an email and, if your mobile number is on the staff list, an SMS. These messages only give the memo reference and the step. Sign in to see the details.

Your name, top right

Press your name to open your profile, change your password, manage two-factor sign-in, or **Sign out**. Sign out when you leave your computer.

3 Your staff list

Only officers on the staff list can be added to a team. HR loads most of the list. If someone in your department is missing, add them yourself.

1. Open **Staff list** and search for the officer first, to be sure they are not there already.
2. Press **Add officer**. Fill in the name, PF number, designation, employment type, job grade, official email and mobile number. Press **Save**.
3. To add many at once, press **Import**, choose the filled-in list, press **Check file** and read what will be added before you import.

> **The job grade matters.** It sets the officer's DSA rate. Casuals are on scale 10, and attachees without a grade on INTERN. Mobile numbers are Kenyan numbers such as 0712 345 678.

You can correct officers you added yourself. You cannot deactivate an officer or change anyone's position or system access. When someone leaves, is transferred or is promoted, tell HR or the System Administrator.

4 Your workplan and budget

Each financial year (July to June), your department prepares a workplan and budget estimates. Once the CEO approves it, your memos are charged to its lines.

1. Open **Workplan and budget** and choose the financial year at the top.
2. To work in Excel, press **Workplan template**, fill it in and keep it ready.
3. Press **Prepare or import the workplan**. Choose your filled-in file under **Workplan in Excel**, or leave it empty and type the lines in yourself.
4. For each line, check the objective, deliverables, quantity and unit cost, the quarters and the responsible officer. Fill in the **Objectives for the year**.
5. Press **Submit to the CEO** and confirm. The lines are now locked.

The CEO may comment on the workplan, change a line's amount or return it to you. If it is returned, the alert and an orange box tell you why. Make the changes and press **Resubmit to the CEO**. Your original figures are kept beside the CEO's, and every step is listed in the **Review history**.

> **Good to know.** Only an approved budget counts. Until the CEO approves it, your memos show no allocation. After approval, the lines are changed only by budget adjustments, which the Office of the CEO handles.

5 Preparing an activity memo

1. Open **Activity memos** and press **Create new activity memo**.
2. Fill in the memo. The table below explains each part.
3. Press **Save draft**. You can come back to a draft at any time from the **Drafts** tab.

Part of the form	What to put
Title and purpose	A short, clear title and one sentence on what the activity is for.
Category and activity type	Choose the closest from the lists.
Introduction and justification	Why the activity is needed now. You can add more sections, such as a programme, under **More memo sections**.
Memo reference (REF NO) and date issued	Your department's memo reference and the memo date. Both are required.
Dates	The first day and the number of days. OCEO works out the nights for DSA.
Locations	County, constituency and venue. Press **Add location** for more than one place.
Budget line	The line in your approved budget to charge. OCEO shows the allocation and the balance still available beside it.

> **Watch the budget position.** The memo shows your department's allocation, what has been spent, what is committed to approved memos, what is pending and the balance. If the balance is too low, talk to the Office of the CEO before you submit.

6 Adding the team and the costs

On the memo, open **Team and costs**.

1. Press **Add officers**, search by name or filter by department, tick the officers, choose their role (for example **Team lead** or **Member**) and press **Add to team**.
2. For people outside the Board, press **Add external participant**. For a large group without names, such as 40 youth, press **Add a group by number**.
3. OCEO adds each officer's DSA by itself. Press **Add cost line** for anything else: air tickets, fuel, vehicle hire, venue and so on.

How DSA is worked out

- One rate per job grade, wherever the activity takes place.
- An activity of two days or more pays the night before the start (for travel) and every night up to the end. For example, a 3-day activity pays 4 nights.
- A one-day activity pays no nights.

When an officer is not available

An officer already on an approved activity on the same days cannot be added, and you will see why. An officer on a memo that is still waiting for a decision shows a warning, but you can still add them. Only the Office of the CEO can override this, with a reason. If one of your officers is needed elsewhere, talk to the Office of the CEO.

7 Checking and submitting the memo

1. Press **Preview memo**. OCEO builds the memo in the Board's template with the budget annex and the list of participants. Read it as the CEO will. The total must agree everywhere.
2. If anything is missing, OCEO lists it. Fix each item before you submit.
3. Press **Submit for review** and choose the **Assistant Chief of Staff** or the **Chief of Staff**.
4. If you are acting in the role, tick **I am signing in an acting capacity**. The memo then reads "Ag." before your designation. Your record on the staff list does not change.
5. Confirm. The memo moves to **Awaiting review and decision** and is locked.

> **Before you submit, check it well.** A draft can be thrown away with **Discard draft**. Once it is submitted, a memo is never deleted. It can only be returned, declined or cancelled.

8 When a memo comes back to you

A reviewer or the CEO may return a memo for correction. You get an alert and an email, and the memo appears on the **Returned for correction** tab.

1. Open the memo and read the reviewer's comment at the top.
2. Press **Edit memo**, or open **Team and costs**, and make the changes asked for.
3. Preview it again, then press **Resubmit for review**. It goes back to the same office.

Comments are kept as written, so you and the reviewers can always see what was asked and when.

9 After the CEO decides

You are told when the CEO approves or declines your memo. An approved memo moves to **Approved and authorised**. When the CEO approves it, the CEO also instructs Finance to process the imprest and Supply Chain to procure the tickets, and may instruct other departments, for example Administration for a vehicle. You are told when each instruction is done, with its reference, such as the imprest number.

From the start date, the activity is shown as in progress, and it is completed after the end date. If something changes after approval, such as the dates, the team or the costs, contact the Office of the CEO. Some changes go back to the CEO.

10 Reporting after the activity

The activity report is due **7 working days after the end date**. OCEO records whether it came in on time.

1. Open the memo and press **Submit activity report**.
2. Write what the activity achieved, the key findings and your recommendations. Attach the report document.
3. Under each cost line, type the amount actually spent. Type 0 for anything not used, such as DSA for an officer who did not travel.
4. Press **Submit report**.

The amounts you enter count as spent against your budget straight away. If the report is returned, press **Correct and resubmit the report**, make the change and submit it again. When the Office of the CEO accepts it, the activity is closed and can no longer be changed.

11 Asking an officer to prepare a memo

You can ask an officer on your staff list to draft a memo for you. They do not need an account.

1. On **Activity memos** press **Ask an officer to prepare a memo**.
2. Choose the officer, say what the memo is for, choose how many days the link works (up to 30) and press **Send the link**.
3. The officer opens the link and types a six-digit code sent to their email or mobile. They prepare the memo and send it to you.
4. Open it from the **Prepared by officers** tab. You can forward it for review, use **Return to the officer** with a comment, or **Decline** it.

While the officer has the memo, you cannot edit it. Once you forward it, it is your memo and follows the usual steps. To stop a link at once, press **Revoke** on the memo requests list.

12 When the CEO instructs your department

If you head Finance, Supply Chain or any department the CEO instructs, you will see **Instructions** in the menu.

1. Open the instruction. It shows what you need to act on: the reference, the dates, the places, the team, the CEO's note and, for Finance and Supply Chain, the cost lines.
2. Press **Acknowledge** so the Office of the CEO knows you have it.
3. When it is done, press **Mark as done** and type the reference, such as the imprest or LPO number.

Once the memo is approved, you can also read it and its documents. You cannot change anything on it.

13 Quick answers

The tabs on Activity memos

Tab	What is there
Drafts	Memos you have started but not submitted.
Prepared by officers	Memos officers are preparing for you, or have sent to you.

Returned for correction	Memos sent back to you. These need you.
Awaiting review and decision	Memos with the reviewers or the CEO.
Approved and authorised	Approved memos, including those whose report is due.
Declined	Memos the CEO declined, with the reason.
All	Every memo your department has.

Common questions

Question	Answer
I cannot add an officer to my team.	They are on another approved activity on those days, or they are not on the staff list. Check the message beside their name.
The memo shows no budget allocation.	Your workplan and budget for this year has not been approved yet, or you chose a line that is not in it.
Submit for review is refused.	Something is missing, often the REF NO, the date issued or a team. OCEO lists what to fix.
I made a mistake after submitting.	Ask the reviewer to return the memo to you so you can correct it.
The DSA amount looks wrong.	Check the officer's job grade on the staff list and the number of days on the memo.
I am leaving the role or going on leave.	Tell the Office of the CEO. They can hand your role to a successor, from today or a later date. Your memos stay with the department.
I am locked out.	Use **Forgot password?**. Resetting your password unlocks your account.
My email or phone number has changed.	Ask HR or the System Administrator to update the staff list. Alerts go to what is recorded there.

14 Getting help

For	Contact
Sign-in, password or account problems	The System Administrator (ICT)
A memo, a review comment or a decision	The Office of the CEO: the Chief of Staff or the Assistant Chief of Staff
Officers missing or wrong on the staff list	Human Resources
Budget lines and allocations	The Office of the CEO

> **When you ask for help,** give the memo reference and say what you pressed and what you saw. A screenshot helps. Never send your password to anyone, including ICT.